Tomáš Haufer

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Education

CERGE-EI, Charles University & Czech Academy of Sciences — Prague, Czech Republic
Master in Economic Research (MA) — Sep. 2025 – Jun. 2027 (expected)

- Grade average **1.00/1.00** (all A), 66 ECTS — first year of the programme.

Prague University of Economics and Business (VŠE) — Prague, Czech Republic
Bachelor's Degree in Economics — Sep. 2022 – Jun. 2025

- Graduated in the **top 10%** of the cohort.
- Thesis: *The Laffer Curve in the Czech Republic*; supervisor: Pavel Potužák.

University of Agder (UiA) — Kristiansand, Norway
Erasmus+ Exchange Programme — Jan. 2024 – May 2024

- 27.5 ECTS: Business Analytics, Public Administration and Management, Norwegian.

Additional training: BREAD–IGC virtual PhD-level course in Political Economy, Sep.–Nov. 2026; Prague–Glasgow Summer School in Economics (VŠE and University of Glasgow), 2024; Mises Academy, Institute of Liberal Studies, Prague, 2024.

Research Interests

Economic History · Institutional and Political Economy · Applied Economics

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Clara Sievert (full-time Jun.–Sep., part-time Oct.–Dec.) — CERGE-EI, Prague
Religion and development: data analysis of a field RCT in the DRC — Jun. 2026 – Dec. 2026

- Programmed a Stata and Python pipeline that automates thousands of regressions on original data from four types of surveys and visualises the results in interactive dashboards, many of my own design.
- Presented results to Clara Sievert and her co-authors Nathan Nunn, Jonathan Weigel and Marina Ngoma; developed the analysis and output code with AI coding agents (Claude Code), verified by automated checks.
- Early-stage projects on Dutch and Czech economic history with Clara Sievert and Felipe Valencia Caicedo, drawing on large-scale digitised historical records and assessing the feasibility of new data sources.

Moody's Analytics — Prague, Czech Republic
Economic Analysis Summer Intern — Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Updated the Moody's Précis® Report for Romania, analysing the country's key macroeconomic indicators.
- Assisted with writing EViews scripts for data work on the Economic Scenarios for Climate Risk project and performed quality checks on forecast time series.
- Authored two published Economic View commentaries (CEE outlook; UAE oil shock) and contributed to work on exchange-rate equations in the Global Macroeconomic Model.

Research in Progress

The Fateful Adventures of the Good Soldiers — MA thesis + paper
Loyalty, Desertion, and the Czechoslovak Legions (supervisor: Sebastian Ottinger) — Feb. 2026 – present

- Asks how soldiers' nationalist and political views shaped two desertion decisions by the same men: from the Habsburg army into the Czechoslovak Legions, and later from the Legions themselves — a volunteer force, so staying reflects commitment, not fear of punishment.
- Assembles ~300,000 individual soldier records from two archival datasets (~133,000 of them legionnaires), not previously used in economic research.

- Digitises the 1910 census gazetteer (*Lexikon obcí*) of Bohemia, Moravia, and Silesia — the only source reaching settlement level — for population, houses, language, confession, and institutions (schools, courts, post, rail, banks, and Czech- or German-language cooperatives as nationalism proxies).

Written in Time Term Project, CERGE-EI

Emotional and stylistic structure in the Project Gutenberg corpus Feb. 2026 – May 2026

- Built a dataset of 59,969 English-language books × 79 features (emotion scores, stylometric measures, semantic fields) from Project Gutenberg metadata and full texts.
- Residualised the features on decade, country, and genre fixed effects, then applied clustering and network analysis; language shifts towards fear and conflict after 1914.

What Drives Referee Performance? Term Project, CERGE-EI

The effect of referee coaches on referee performance Oct. 2025 – Jan. 2026

- Built an original panel dataset on referee performance, education, and career progression in Czech floorball (two regions, 2023/24–2024/25) by scraping and matching sources; estimated the effect of coaches' observations with multiple fixed effects and clustered standard errors in Python.

Policy Commentary and Writing

Central and Eastern Europe Outlook: United in Diversity, Moody's Analytics Aug. 2025

Shifting Sands: The UAE Under an Oil Shock (with Thomas Sgouralis), Moody's Analytics Aug. 2025

Diary of an Econ Student — econdiary.substack.com, a data-driven economics blog Sep. 2025 – present

Skills

Programming: Python, R, STATA, EViews, LaTeX; LLM-assisted pipelines (Claude Code).

Empirical methods: Panel data and fixed effects; archival record linkage and census digitisation; web scraping and dataset construction; unsupervised learning; time series; IV/2SLS and GMM.

Languages: Czech (native), English (C1, Cambridge FCE Grade A), German (A2–B1), Norwegian (A1).

Test scores: TOEFL iBT 5.5/6 (Reading 6.0, Listening 6.0, Speaking 5.5, Writing 5.0), Sep. 2026; GRE Quantitative 164, Verbal 155, Analytical Writing 4.0, Oct. 2026.

Teaching and Service

Czech Floorball — Referee Coach and Member of the Regional Committee May 2023 – May 2027

Hradec Králové and Pardubice region. Teach at referee certification seminars and train new referee coaches; mentor referees and compile the statistics used for nominations. Voted the region's best referee coach (2023/24; third in 2022/23).

FBC Trutnov (DTJ) — Secretary / Manager Apr. 2023 – May 2027

Run a medium-sized sports club: budgeting, competition entries, logistics, partnerships, marketing.

Other Professional Experience

Siemens, s.r.o. — Trainee, Social Media and Communications, Trutnov Aug. 2023 – Feb. 2025

Investown Technologies, s.r.o. — Finance Analyst Intern, Prague Feb. 2023 – Jun. 2023

References

Sebastian Ottinger
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Clara Sievert
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